

**Board 1**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 8 7 5 2

♥ K 4

♦ K 9 7

♣ Q 8 5

♠ A Q 9

♥ A 7 5 3

♦ A J 6 4

♣ A K



♠ 6 3

♥ J 10 9 8 2

♦ Q 10 2

♣ 9 7 4

♠ K J 4

♥ Q 6

♦ 8 5 3

♣ J 10 6 3 2

West

North

East

South

2♣

Pass

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♠5.

Winners: ♠=3 ♥=1 ♦=1 ♣=2 Total = 7

Needing two winners you will naturally consider your 5-card ♣ suit. After unblocking the ♣ A K you will need two entries to your hand; one to lead the ♣J and drive out the ♣Q, then a second to enjoy your good ♣s.

The ♠ suit will provide one entry easily, but should you depend on the ♥Q for the second entry?

No, for two reasons. Firstly the ♥Q only gives you a 50% chance of being an entry. But more importantly, you already have your two sure entries in ♠s. As long as you take the first trick with dummy's ♠A both your ♠K and ♠J can be entries.

Win the ♠A. Play off dummy's ♣ A K. Lead the ♠9 to your ♠J. Play your ♣J (and another one if necessary) to establish the ♣ suit. Win whatever red card they play next with dummy's Ace. Play the ♠Q to your ♠K and cash your established ! C(s). Dummy's other red Ace will be your ninth trick.

The more you make a point of looking for entries the easier they are to find.

You'd have to be very careless to miss this one.

**Board 3**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 8 5  
 ♥ K 7 2  
 ♦ 8 6 4  
 ♣ Q 10 7 5

♠ 10 7

♥ 8 6 5

♦ K Q 7 3

♣ J 9 4 2



♠ A 6 4 3

♥ A J 4

♦ A J

♣ A K 8 3

♠ K J 9 2

♥ Q 10 9 3

♦ 10 9 5 2

♣ 6

| West     | North | East | South |
|----------|-------|------|-------|
| Pass     | Pass  | Pass | 2NT   |
| Pass     | 3NT   |      |       |
| All Pass |       |      |       |

3NT by South

Then unblock your ♦ A J. Next play ♣ K. (on which East discards), and a small ♣ toward dummy's ♣ J 9. You are sure to have a ♣ entry to dummy's ♦ s, and you will still get three ♣ tricks, just a different three.

Suppose the opening lead had been a ♦ rather than a ♣.

You probably would have played the hand the same way you just did, unblock ♦ s, then play ♣ A K and a low ♣ toward the ♣ J 9 trying to get a ♣ entry to dummy.

It is only because the ♣ opening lead gives you the chance for a Cheap-Trick that you are tempted to go wrong.

South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♣ 5. You play low from dummy and East plays the ♣ 6.

Winners: ♠ = 1 ♥ = 1 ♦ = 4? ♣ = 3 Total = 9

Although you have 4 ♦ winners, getting to the last couple might not be so easy. You can make 3 ♦ tricks simply by winning your ♦ A, then overtaking your ♦ J with dummy's ♦ Q. But you need that fourth ♦ winner. Can you get it?

Sure you can, by creating an entry in ♣ s. It is likely from the opening lead, (and East's play of a small card), that West has led from ♣ Q 10 7 5. If you win the first trick cheaply then you will still make your ♣ A K for three ♣ tricks in all.

So don't win cheaply, win the first trick with the ♣ A. Then unblock your ♦ A J. Next play ♣ K. (on which East discards), and a small ♣ toward dummy's ♣ J 9. You are sure to have a ♣ entry to dummy's ♦ s, and you will still get three ♣ tricks, just a different three.

**Board 5**

North Deals  
None Vul

♠ Q J 10 9 5  
♥ A 9 3  
♦ 9 8 3  
♣ 10 8

♠ 8 3  
♥ J 7 4  
♦ A 6 4 2  
♣ 7 6 5 3



♠ K 7 4 2  
♥ Q 10 8 6  
♦ 10 7  
♣ K 9 2

♠ A 6  
♥ K 5 2  
♦ K Q J 5  
♣ A Q J 4

| <i>West</i>  | <i>North</i> | <i>East</i> | <i>South</i> |
|--------------|--------------|-------------|--------------|
|              | Pass         | Pass        | 2NT          |
| Pass         | 3NT          |             |              |
| All Pass     |              |             |              |
| 3NT by South |              |             |              |